Reading and writing

2026-12-18 | Week 9 | Show what you learned

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D

3.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution. In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved. 3.7D: Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order. In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order. Today: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C

4.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution. In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution. 4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice.

I Do

Book connection: Retell the complete problem-action-result chain and support it with a page or picture. Read a short, accessible scene from Big Pumpkin. Show a visual sequence strip: beginning, middle, end. Ask the shared WH question, "Who is here, where are they, and what happens first?" Model pointing to a picture, choosing an answer card, using AAC or dictating a sentence. Then connect the same scene to each learner's target: Grade 3 explain how a character's action changes what happens next.; Grade 4 use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice..

We Do

Return to Big Pumpkin and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Reread the same scene aloud. Both learners use the same book, illustrations and three-part sequence mat. Ask who, what, where, when, why and how questions about the beginning, middle and end. Grade 3 arranges picture cards and answers with pointing, speech, AAC or dictation. Grade 4 explains the event, character action or evidence using the same page. Fade the model, switch teacher rotations, then revisit the visual sequence.

You Do

Use one fresh WH question about Big Pumpkin: "What happened at the beginning, middle or end, and how do you know?" Grade 3: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. Grade 4: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. Record the page or illustration, response mode, prompt level and whether the student identified the story-structure element.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: The learner not with the teacher uses a previously taught three-picture sequence, WH picture sort, character/setting match or known Vizzle task from Big Pumpkin. When finished, the learner may complete the week's book craft or quiet enrichment. The teacher then switches and teaches the other learner from the same scene.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Real books: Big Pumpkin. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Book connection for this subject

Big Pumpkin | Retell the complete problem-action-result chain and support it with a page or picture.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

After the shared read-aloud and comprehension sequence, each learner makes an individual response from the same book. Grade 3: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. Grade 4: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. Offer large primary writing lines, a picture-to-sentence frame, tracing, dictation or AAC. Record composition separately from oral or picture evidence.

Visual WH and story-structure routine

Use the same book for both learners. Show who, what, where, when, why and how picture cards. Ask about the beginning, middle and end. Arrange three scene cards, then let each learner answer with pointing, AAC, speech, dictation or writing. Record the response mode and prompt level.

Craft or enrichment after comprehension

Create a learning-gallery display with a pumpkin problem/solution sequence and one evidence card.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Big Pumpkin by Erica Silverman. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-12-18 | Week 9 | Show what you learned

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.7D, 3.7E

3.7D: Determine when it is appropriate to use measurements of liquid volume (capacity) or weight. In plain English: Decide whether a situation calls for measuring weight or liquid capacity. 3.7E: Determine liquid volume (capacity) or weight using appropriate units and tools. In plain English: Measure weight or liquid capacity with the right tool and units. Today: Choose the correct tool, measure a new object or amount of water, and record the number with its unit.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B, 4.3E

4.3A: Represent a fraction a/b as a sum of fractions 1/b, where a and b are whole numbers and b > 0, including when a > b. In plain English: Build fractions, including amounts greater than one, by adding unit fractions. 4.3B: Decompose a fraction in more than one way into a sum of fractions with the same denominator using concrete and pictorial models and recording results with symbolic representations. In plain English: Break a fraction into same-denominator sums in more than one way; show models and equations. 4.3E: Represent and solve addition and subtraction of fractions with equal denominators using objects and pictorial models that build to the number line and properties of operations. In plain English: Model and solve fraction addition and subtraction with equal denominators. Today: Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

I Do

Book connection: Measure and share pumpkin models, then show the final week's fraction or capacity reasoning. Grade 3: Choose a balance with gram weights to measure a classroom object, or a marked measuring cup to measure water in milliliters. Name the tool, number and unit. Grade 4: Join one fourth and two fourths to make three fourths. Remove one fourth from three fourths. Build one whole plus one half.

We Do

Return to Big Pumpkin and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 4: build 3/4 as 1/4 + 1/4 + 1/4 and again as 1/4 + 2/4. Record both equations and explain why the same whole and denominator stay fixed.

You Do

Grade 3: Choose the correct tool, measure a new object or amount of water, and record the number with its unit. Grade 4: Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention. Add a visual or prop from Big Pumpkin that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Big Pumpkin | Measure and share pumpkin models, then show the final week's fraction or capacity reasoning.

Science

2026-12-18 | Week 9 | Show what you learned

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A, 3.8B

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. 3.8B: Plan and conduct investigations that demonstrate how the speed of an object is related to its mechanical energy. In plain English: Plan and carry out a test connecting an object's speed to its mechanical energy. Today: Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.7, 4.8A

4.7: Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object. In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism. 4.8A: Investigate and identify the transfer of energy by objects in motion, waves in water, and sound. In plain English: Investigate how moving objects, water waves and sound transfer energy. Today: Use a tested model to explain a force or energy transfer.

I Do

Book connection: Choose one energy or motion idea from the story setting, test it, and explain the observed evidence. Grade 3: Choose a familiar motion investigation and make a model or photo display. Grade 4: Build a model of an investigated force or energy transfer.

We Do

Return to Big Pumpkin and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same. Grade 3: plan two releases of the same car, one slow and one faster, into the same lightweight foam block. Keep the car, block, surface and collision point fixed; reset the block and repeat three trials per condition. Record observed speed and how far the block moves. Use the greater observed effect as evidence about mechanical energy; do not use travel distance alone as a speed measurement.

You Do

Grade 3: Demonstrate the tested change and communicate one observation. Grade 4: Demonstrate the change and communicate evidence for the explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Balance, rock, cotton ball, measuring cup, two containers, tray, fraction strips, project photos. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only. Add a visual or prop from Big Pumpkin that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Big Pumpkin | Choose one energy or motion idea from the story setting, test it, and explain the observed evidence.

Social studies

2026-12-18 | Week 9 | Show what you learned

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.1A

3.1A: Describe how individuals, events, and ideas have changed communities, past and present. In plain English: Explain how people, events and ideas have changed communities. Today: Show a community problem, action and result.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.3E

4.3E: Explain the events that led to the annexation of Texas to the United States and the impact of the U.S.-Mexican War. In plain English: Explain how Texas became part of the United States and the effects of the U.S.-Mexican War. Today: Explain how a Republic event connects to statehood.

I Do

Book connection: Present a problem, a group action and the result using the story's shared-work structure. Grade 3: Show a community problem, action and result. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Explain how a Republic event connects to statehood. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Return to Big Pumpkin and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Work together with a second example from the same source set. One visual, one explanation, one teacher follow-up question. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Show a community problem, action and result. Grade 4: Explain how a Republic event connects to statehood. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. Use three fresh items for the Friday subject check. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources. Add a visual or prop from Big Pumpkin that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Big Pumpkin | Present a problem, a group action and the result using the story's shared-work structure.